

Title: INTRODUCTION TO MILITARY MAPS AND CONVENTIONAL SIGNS

National Cadet Corps (NCC) â Official Directorate General Training Notes

1. DEFINITION OF A MAP: A map is a scaled, flat graphical representation of a portion of the earth's surface showing both natural features (mountains, rivers, forests) and artificial man-made works (roads, bridges, settlements, railway lines).

2. SURVEY OF INDIA TOPOGRAPHICAL SHEETS: The standard military topographical maps used by the Indian Armed Forces are produced by the Survey of India, predominantly at a scale of 1:50,000, wherein 2 centimeters on the map represents exactly 1 kilometer on the physical ground.

3. CONVENTIONAL COLORS & SYMBOLS: Military maps use four standard colors: Blue denotes all water bodies (lakes, rivers, canals); Green signifies natural vegetation, jungle, and orchards; Yellow designates cultivated agricultural land; Red and Black denote roads, settlements, surveyed heights, and printed grid lines.

4. MAP MARGINAL INFORMATION: Every map sheet contains critical marginal information including the Sheet Number, Edition, Index to Adjoining Sheets, Scale Bar, Contour Interval (typically 20 meters), and Magnetic Declination Diagram.